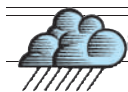


The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

SU V1 V2 V3 V4



Shower 76/67 • Tomorrow: Mostly sunny 82/65 **B20**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

FRIDAY, AUGUST 1, 2025 • \$4

Plane got no warning helicopter was near

FAA acknowledges possible controller error before midair collision

BY IAN DUNCAN, RACHEL WEINER AND MICHAEL LARIS

An air traffic controller should have alerted the crew of a passenger jet that an Army helicopter was speeding toward their aircraft on Jan. 29, a Federal Aviation Administration official affirmed in testimony Thursday, the agency's first acknowledgment of a possible error in the Reagan National Airport control tower immediately before the fatal collision.

The focus on the lapse emerged on the second day of a National Transportation Safety Board hearing that is delving into the causes of the midair crash, which killed 67 people.

The hearing featured testimony about a high number of takeoffs and landings at the airport, combined with heavy helicopter traffic, that led to air traffic controllers "pushing the line" on safety, in the words of a tower manager.

The tactics included frequent use of "visual separation," which allows helicopter crews to use their own judgment and skills to avoid other traffic, as well as the use of Runway 33, which is shorter and requires jets arriving from the south to leave the usual flight path and travel farther east.

The controller who was responsible for guiding the flights of the helicopter and the airliner had

SEE CRASH ON A4

Higher tariffs to hit nations in a week, Trump says

New rates for dozens of trading partners had been set to roll out today

BY DAVID J. LYNCH AND RACHEL LERMAN

President Donald Trump on Thursday finalized his long-awaited and much-delayed "reciprocal" tariffs in a move designed to rebalance a global trading system that he argues has been tilted against the world's largest economy, the White House said.

In a pair of executive orders, the president increased tariffs on merchandise from about 70 countries and raised the rate on products made in Canada, one of the United States' largest trading partners, to a punitive 35 percent.

Higher tariff rates were scheduled to kick in Friday, but now won't take effect for another week to give Customs and Border Protection officials time to prepare. However, the new tariff rate on Canada will still take effect on Friday, the administration clarified late Thursday.

U.S. diplomats led by Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent in recent weeks have reached trade deal

SEE TRADE ON A16

Canada: Trump puts trade deal in doubt over Palestinian issue. **A13**

Tariff 'rebates': GOP senators largely oppose Trump's idea. **A15**

A night of bombardment in Kyiv



EFREM LUKATSKY/AP

Women mourn outside a Kyiv apartment building after a Russian strike early Thursday. Missile and drone attacks killed at least 16 people, including a 6-year-old, and injured more than 150 across the city. Among the injured were 12 children, a number the mayor said was the highest in one night in Kyiv since the war began in 2022. **Story, A12**

The Trump lawyer on top of the Epstein case

BY SHAYNA JACOBS AND MICHAEL KRANISH

Five months ago, Todd Blanche was asked at his Senate confirmation hearing whether being President Donald Trump's lawyer in his hush money trial and other cases meant he would have a "continuing duty of loyalty and confidentiality" to his former client even

after becoming deputy attorney general.

"Yes," Blanche responded, citing his "attorney-client relationship with President Trump."

Now that loyalty — and the question of a potential conflict of interest — has become a key component of the questions swirling about Trump's friendship with Jeffrey Epstein, who was charged

with sex trafficking and died in prison in 2019. The second-ranking Justice Department official is at the center of a controversial effort to reexamine the Epstein case, the results of which could reopen high-stakes litigation that concluded years ago and play a role in defining aspects of Trump's legacy.

After weeks of furor about

whether the Justice Department would release much of its file on Epstein — and amid speculation about whether the file had information about Trump and others — Blanche traveled to Florida to interview Epstein's longtime

SEE BLANCHE ON A5

DOJ picks: To retain appointees, Trump leans on untested tactics. **A6**



SCOTT STEPHEN BALL/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Texas flood investigation

A law enforcement officer prays in front of an annotated map of the Guadalupe River on Thursday in Kerrville during a special legislative hearing about last month's disaster. **Story, A3**

As Democrats look forward, ghosts of 2024 shadow them

BY HANNAH KNOWLES AND MAEVE RESTON

Former vice president Kamala Harris is promoting a book about her losing 2024 presidential campaign, leaving the door open to another White House bid in 2028 and building a group that would enable her to hit the trail for fellow Democrats in the midterms.

Former president Joe Biden told a gala of judges and lawyers Thursday night that President Donald Trump's administration was "doing its best to dismantle the Constitution." Such sparring with Trump, combined with congressional hearings and campaign books, has kept Biden in the news, along with questions about his health and acuity in the White House.

And his son Hunter Biden has been settling scores on podcasts, lashing out at political consultants, influencers and actor

George Clooney for criticizing his father — to the dismay of Democrats who believe the younger Biden's legal troubles hurt them in 2024.

Democrats are eager to turn the page on their 2024 losses — but their central figures from the last election keep stepping back into the spotlight, complicating their efforts to forge a new identity. Many in the party are wary of elevating the people who led them to defeat in 2024 and exasperated to see the drama of that election repeatedly relitigated when they want to keep the focus on pushing back against Trump's second-term agenda and identifying new leaders.

"The shadow of 2024 is long, and I think all perspectives in the mix believe we need something fresh," said longtime Democratic consultant Donna Bojarsky. Many Democrats do not blame Harris for what went wrong last

SEE DEMOCRATS ON A4

Ballroom that Trump has long sought anchors planned East Wing remake

BY JONATHAN EDWARDS

President Donald Trump, a longtime developer, is overseeing the construction of a \$200 million, 90,000-square-foot ballroom that will remake the East Wing of the White House, effecting one of the biggest changes to "the People's House" in a century.

The White House State Ballroom will seat 650 people, more

than triple the capacity of the East Room, which is currently the largest room at the White House. Construction is set to begin in September and be done "long before" the end of Trump's second term.

The project, long on Trump's wish list, seeks to solve a problem White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt said has frustrated the president and his predecessors:

a lack of space for major functions that requires "a large and unsightly tent" about 300 feet from the main building entrance.

"They've wanted a ballroom at the White House for more than 150 years, but there's never been a president that was good at ballrooms — really good, in fact," Trump said at a news conference Thursday, adding: "When they have big events — you entertain

the president of China, the president of any place — and you have big crowds, they've always had a tent."

The ballroom is Trump's latest and most ambitious effort to leave his mark on one of the world's most iconic buildings, one that will endure long after he leaves. Other items have drawn his focus in the opening six months of his term. Since taking office in Janu-

ary, he has paved over the Rose Garden's lawn, vowed to replace a "terribly" remodeled bathroom in the Lincoln Bedroom and installed twin 88-foot flagpoles on the north and south lawns of the White House, each flying massive American flags.

SEE WHITE HOUSE ON A10

Smithsonian: Trump was removed from an impeachment exhibit. **A10**

IN THE NEWS

Violent threats Federal judges speak out about their concerns over attempts by Trump and his allies to intimidate the judiciary. **A6**

Wrongful convictions In Virginia, Richmond and Norfolk are resisting a state law aimed at providing millions in compensation to two men who were imprisoned for years. **B15**

THE NATION

The brain of the gunman in the deadly Park Avenue shooting will be tested, officials said. **A5**
Wildfire smoke and unhealthy air are expected to head east from the Midwest. **A7**

THE WORLD

India's revision of voter rolls could disenfranchise millions, according to critics. **A11**
In an about-face, Ukraine restored the independence of two anti-corruption agencies. **A12**

THE ECONOMY

Student loan borrowers enrolled in the Save repayment plan should consider an exit as the White House winds down the program. **A14**
A Chinese regulator summoned Nvidia representatives to explain alleged vulnerabilities in its H20 chips. **A15**

STYLE

Ms. Rachel, the YouTube star, wants her audience to see the humanity in all people. **B1**

SPORTS

The Nationals sold again at the MLB trade deadline, sending closer Kyle Finnegan and outfielder Alex Call to contenders for prospects. **B9**

THE REGION

A Maryland woman who ran over two children in a crosswalk on their way to school was sentenced to four months in jail. **B15**

WEEKEND

The Air and Space Museum reaches new heights with renovated exhibitions.

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